

OUR LIVES WITH AI

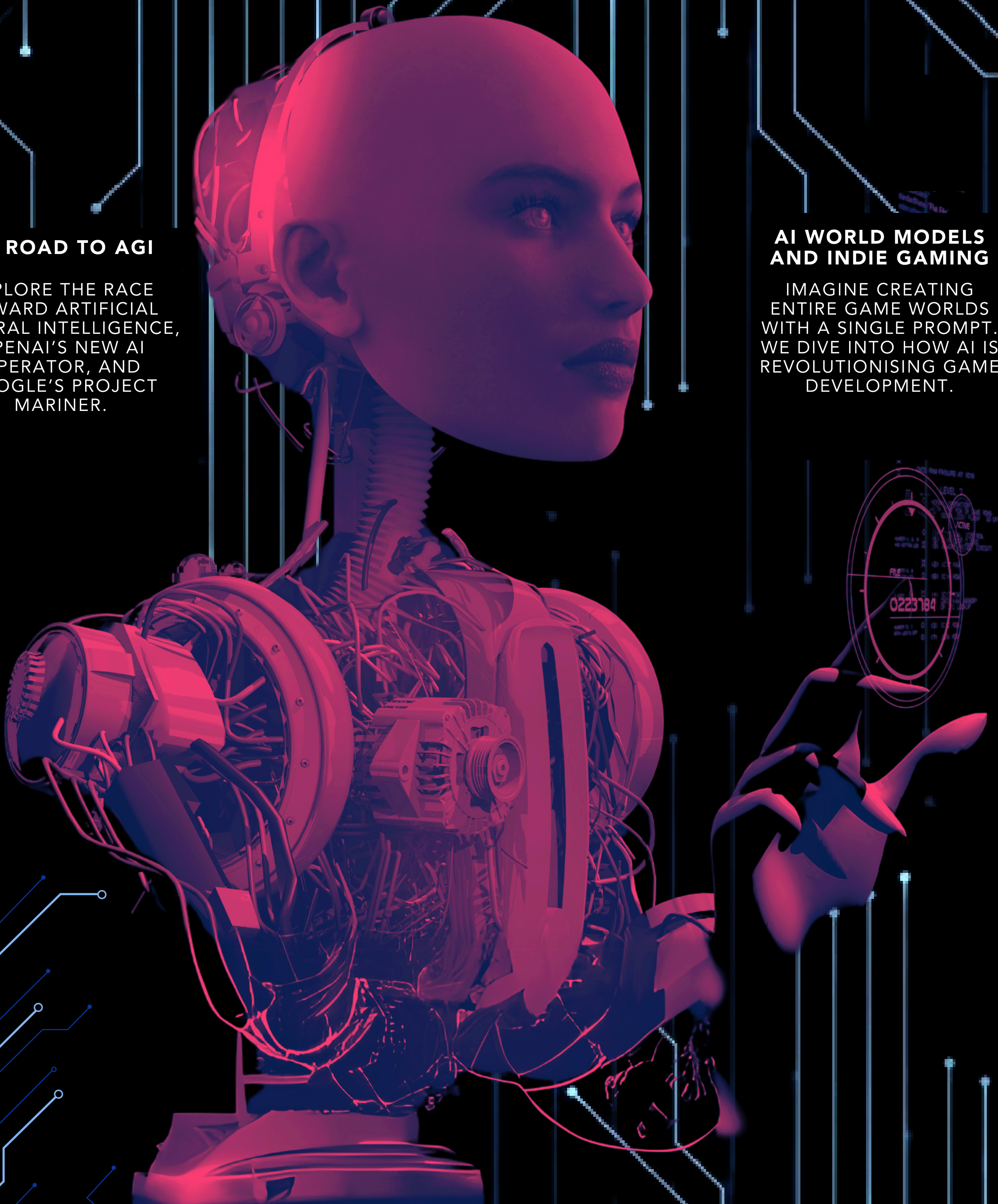
EXPLORING AI'S IMPACT ON
SOCIETY, CULTURE, AND HUMANITY

THE ROAD TO AGI

EXPLORE THE RACE
TOWARD ARTIFICIAL
GENERAL INTELLIGENCE,
OPENAI'S NEW AI
OPERATOR, AND
GOOGLE'S PROJECT
MARINER.

AI WORLD MODELS AND INDIE GAMING

IMAGINE CREATING
ENTIRE GAME WORLDS
WITH A SINGLE PROMPT.
WE DIVE INTO HOW AI IS
REVOLUTIONISING GAME
DEVELOPMENT.



FROM THE INTERNET, TO THE NEW AGE OF AI.

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ROUNDUP

OpenAI's O3 Model Testing Begins

OpenAI launched testing for its latest AI model, O3. Early reports suggest it improves reasoning and contextual understanding, making it highly applicable for business and creative industries.

Google's Quantum Chip Breakthrough

Google unveiled its latest quantum chip, claiming it can significantly speed up AI training. This development could accelerate advances in healthcare and climate science.

Meta's Llama 3.3 Goes Live

Meta released Llama 3.3, a highly accessible AI model for small businesses and independent developers. It's being praised for its cost-effectiveness and versatility.

Nvidia's Robotics Push

Nvidia's Jetson Thor, a high-performance computer for robots, will launch in early 2025, marking a major step in the robotics revolution.

Google Releases Gemini 2.0

Google DeepMind announces Gemini 2.0 AI model, featuring advanced agentic capabilities for dynamic interactions and problem solving under supervision.

WELCOME TO
OUR LIVES
WITH AI
– ISSUE 1



THE AI CONTENT EXPLOSION

Creativity, Copyright, and Chaos

The ability for AI to generate unlimited videos, images, and text of any kind in an instant has flooded the internet. Social media feeds are increasingly becoming littered with AI content, books on Amazon contain AI, and an increasing amount of online sellers have been found using AI in merchandise. It begs the question: With unlimited content and increasing indistinguishable-from-reality AI content, what happens next?

Niche content could serve users more than current content. Picture this: shows targeted for your needs regarding plot and specified niche content. Sound sci-fi? Well, something is already in the works. Showrunner.xyz allows users to create shows with a few prompts. Dubbed the "Netflix of AI," this service makes content creation interactive and personal.

While not perfect, it provides a glimpse into what advancements could be made in this area. Content oversaturation could lead to the slow replacement of original works, although some experts believe AI could be used more as a tool than a replacement.

AI video has expanded massively, with new video models such as SORA and VEO 2 obliterating previous attempts. AI-polished content could create some confusing questions. Could AI-generated content be worthy of copyright? How do we distinguish what is eligible for copyright in a world where AI can generate similar content? If AI content were copyrighted, who would own AI-generated content? The user, the tool's creator, or no one?

IMAGE GENERATION: THREE YEARS OF TRANSFORMATION

“a brown dog walking through a library with a red cowboy hat”



DALL·E Mini – 2021



DALL·E 3 – 2023

DALL·E mini was released as an open-access version of its bigger sibling, DALL·E 1 (which was publicly unavailable at the time). While this model lacked precision and often included distorted features, it showcased the early potential of AI to bring imagination to life.

Two years later, DALL·E 3 transformed the game with a focus on detail, coherence, and contextual understanding. Unlike DALL·E mini, DALL·E 3 mastered complex scenes and produced exceptional realism and accurate images. It incorporated better alignment with user intent and reduced odd or unintended outputs.

THE ROAD TO AGI

ARE WE CLOSE TO A BREAKTHROUGH?

AI Agents vs. Artificial General Intelligence

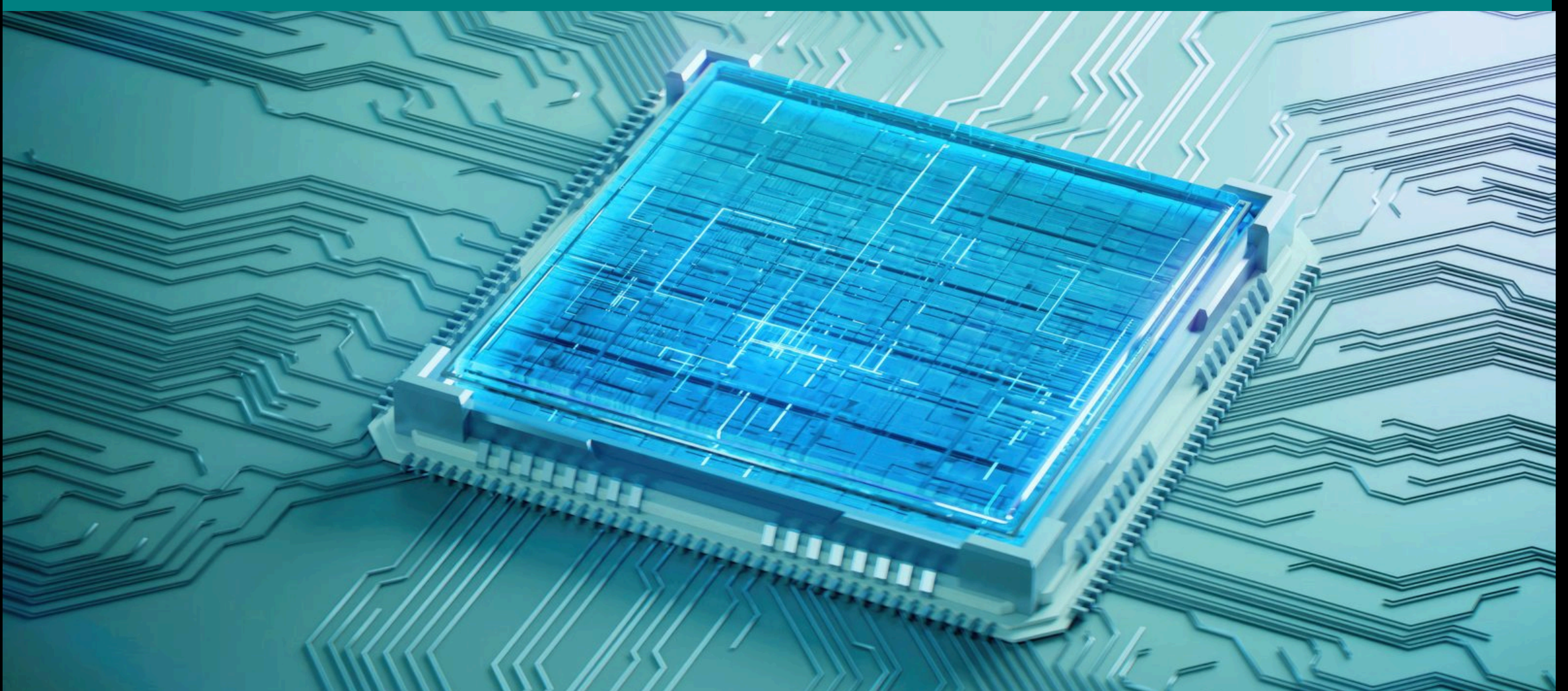
Artificial General Intelligence (AGI) is a widely discussed area in AI. It refers to the goal of AI being capable of adapting to new situations regardless of prior programming for the specific task, adapting to situations like a human can.

AI agents, on the other hand, perform particular tasks by following the rules they are programmed with but cannot think for themselves, operating solely within the instructions they have been given.

AI agents are more sophisticated than regular AI chatbots because they can understand and solve complex problems. For example, an AI agent can determine users' needs and take actionable steps to help them achieve their goals without constant user authorisation.

OpenAI plans to release its first AI operator this month as a research preview. This will require it to take action independently, raising questions about whether this could be the first step toward AGI.

For more on the challenges of AGI development, see our discussion on the limits of AI learning in *The Mind of Machines* (pg. X).



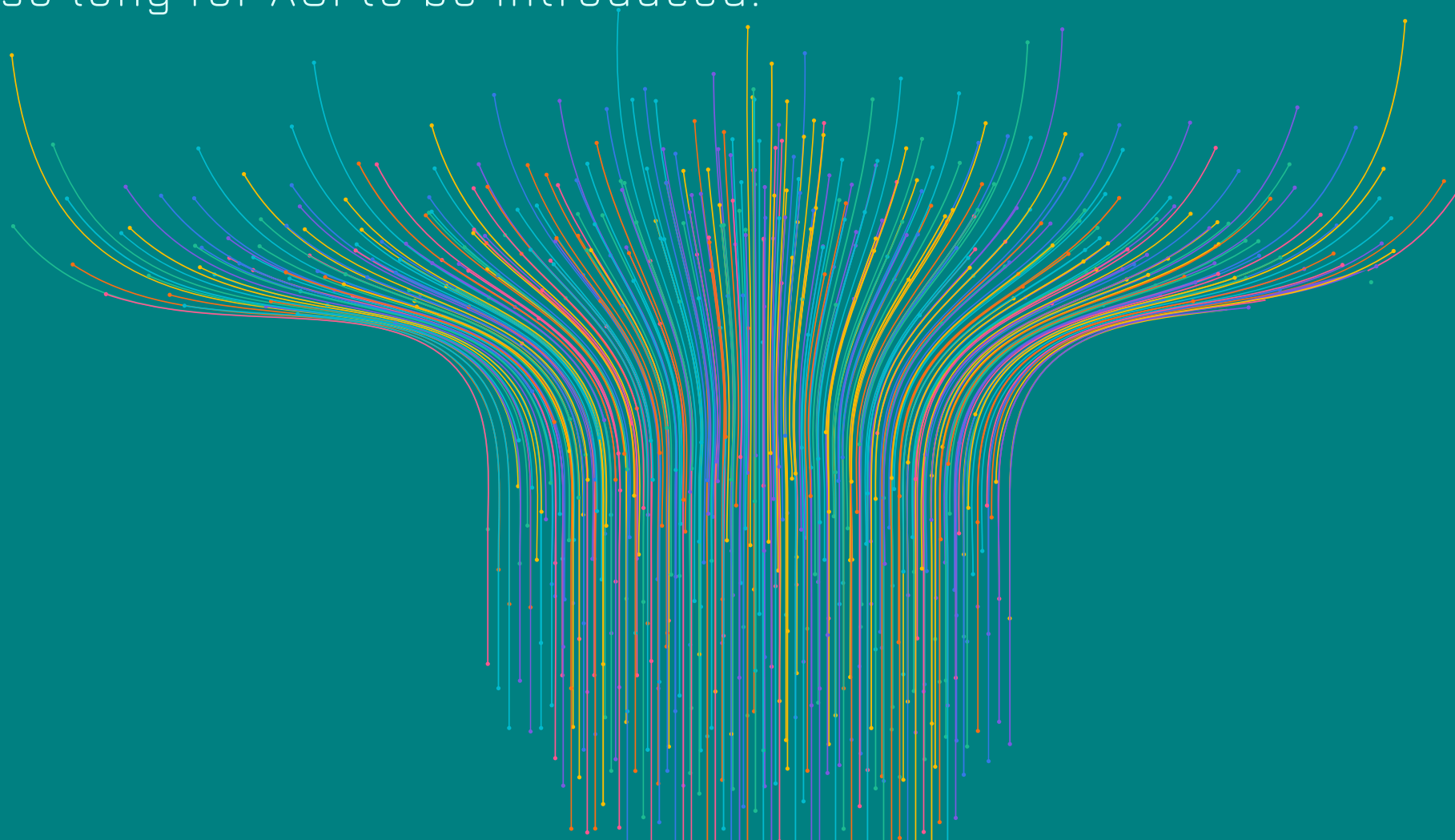
PROJECT MARINER: GOOGLE'S AMBITIOUS AGI ENDEAVOR

With OpenAI's plans to release its first operator soon, Google Deepmind is already one step ahead with its project Mariner, powered by the new Gemini 3 model. Although in a state of limited access, Project Mariner enables AI systems to assist users in web-based interaction through tasks such as research, booking flights, and shopping.

Project Mariner appears as a chat window on the right side of your browser. It accompanies you in searching the web and breaks down complex steps into simple steps for the user. Google's Mariner works by sending screenshots of your browser window to the Gemini 2 model for processing.

Project Mariner is still in its developmental stages with much of its potential yet to be realised. Google Deepmind's Gemini has been prone to hallucinations (for information on hallucination, see page _), and AI malfunction on a larger scale as Project Mariner could be disastrous. Thus, more time is required to prevent critical errors. For example, if a user asks the model to buy an item or book a holiday, the model could unknowingly enter personal information on a malicious website that appears similar (and using AI has been fine-tuned to appear on AGI user prompts), compromising personal data.

Now scale this scenario to 275 million users per month (current monthly Gemini users) who could potentially come into contact with this website, and it's easy to see the issues that could arise. Safety concerns like these are why it is taking so long for AGI to be introduced.



A.L. : A NEW AGE OF INFLUENCERS?





A. L. is not your average influencer; she isn't human. Instead, she is a virtual AI model created by the Clueless Agency. She acts as an alternative to real influencers who often pose challenges to companies, such as disagreements, high costs, and brand misalignment. A. is easier for brands to control and offers a hassle-free and fully customisable option.

A. is portrayed as a 25-year-old fitness influencer from Barcelona. With her personality fine-tuned to resonate with her audience, she earns up to €10,000 a month from working with brands such as Big (a sports supplement category). With over 345k followers, her agency plans her activities weekly to maintain relevance. As an AI model, A. allows for reduced costs compared to human influencers while providing consistency and precision in her brand partnerships.

Many have found the concept of an AI influencer fascinating. Followers engage as though she is real, and many are unaware that she is an AI at first glance. Celebrities even reach out, unaware of this fact. Many sceptics doubt whether AI-generated personas and identities can truly connect with audiences on a personal level.

A. isn't the first virtual celebrity. The first was L. M. , who emerged as a music artist and was created by Brud in 2016. M. amassed a staggering 2.5M followers, showcasing the redefined boundaries of technology merging with influencer culture. Although L. M. was created using CGI, she still showcased the possibilities of virtual personas resonating better with audiences.



HOW AI WORLD MODELS COULD TRANSFORM INDIE GAME DEVELOPMENT

Imagine typing a single prompt and watching it transform into a fully playable game in seconds. This futuristic concept is a reality thanks to Google DeepMind's latest innovation, Genie 2. Genie 2 can generate a diverse 3D environment based on the user's prompt, object interactions, character animations, and interactable NPCs, all based on that environment. Any gamer who desires a niche location that has not been explored can now explore that world all with a simple prompt; for developers, it streamlines a large amount of work by enabling rapid prototypes of game worlds, drastically reducing the cost and time burdens that often come with video game creation.

Indie studios, in particular, could use this to their advantage by generating otherwise costly and time-consuming environments, allowing them to compete with much larger studios.

AI streamlining character dialogue is one area that has already been experimented with, particularly with the game Inworld Origins. This game utilised generated text-based AI for the story of a crime scene, encouraging players to interact with NPCs to uncover clues. Although the dialogue often yielded mixed results, it still serves as an example of how indie companies could leverage AI to provide better experiences to users.

AI's incorporation in video games is currently in its infancy; however, on a larger scale, this technology could provide a truly unique experience that tailors itself to the user's playstyle, providing unlimited replayability and unlimited outcomes. AI could assist in map development and dialogue. With increasingly improved generative AI, it could stretch into soundtracks, sound effects, voice acting, animation, asset creation, and more.

Questions still circulate about how this could affect the gaming industry in the near future, either as a tool or as a replacement for many job positions.

"Some RPG game companies want to use AI for conversation with NPCs, and many will soon use small language models to reduce risk," J. S. told GamerBraves.



J. S.

J. S. is a senior gaming solution architect at Microsoft, working with the Worldwide Gaming Vertical Team. He specialises in integrating AI technologies into game development and operations, shaping how games are designed and managed.

THE RISE OF AI-COFOUNDERS



An AI cofounder refers to an AI contributing to the foundational work of startups, from market research to strategy, assisting in the burdensome process of startup creation. Startups are increasingly relying on AI to reduce costs, scale quicker, and gain a competitive edge, making AI a crucial part of their journey.

AI, for example, can be invaluable in market research. Its ability to analyse patterns and market trends can help identify untapped opportunities and give startups a significant advantage. Product development was once a slow hurdle, but with generative AI, prototypes and visuals for specified needs can be created in an instant.

With AI seamlessly integrating into many of these foundational processes, it's no surprise that it has become a cornerstone of modern startup success. It contributes in minor or major areas to enable more cost-efficient scaling, a major concern for startups. As the technology evolves, the role will undoubtedly expand, continuing to empower startups to turn bold ideas into a reality at an unprecedented pace.

EMERGING AI STARTUPS OF 2025

AI-driven startups like these highlight the diversity of applications that artificial intelligence is revolutionising. They impact more than just AI models themselves; from recycling to robotics, these startups are paving the way for an AI-powered tomorrow.

Recursion

AI-driven drug discovery

Recursion (formerly Exscientia) was founded in 2012 and has increasingly pushed the boundaries of traditional drug discovery by using AI to design and optimise new medicines. The company's AI platform analyses the efficiency and effects drugs will have on the human body, significantly reducing development time and costs. As of 2024, Exscientia launched the EXCYTE-2 trial to use AI to predict drug responses for better acute myeloid leukaemia (AML) treatment, showing how AI is being implemented to assist in adopting better medicine.

Tractable

Automated damage assessment

Tractable uses computer vision technology to transform the insurance industry. Their AI analyses vehicle or property damage images, providing instant repair cost estimates and accelerating the claims process. Founded in 2014, the company has become a trusted partner for global insurers. By 2024, Tractable's AI is streamlining claims and expanding into new markets, including disaster recovery, making it a leader in applying AI to practical, high-stakes scenarios.

PlayHT

Voice Meets Innovation

PlayHT platforms use AI text-to-speech models to provide natural-sounding speech for its customers. These platforms cover a wide range of needs, from podcasts to e-learning material supporting the needs of other companies. Supporting over 900 languages in 142 languages, they offer practical tools for businesses looking to integrate audio into their workforces.

AMP Robotics

AI in recycling

AMP Robotics incorporates AI into the recycling process through automation in the sorting and categorising waste materials to improve efficiency, reduce the need for human labour, and streamline the recycling process, a necessary step in tackling environmental challenges.

AI-DRIVEN SCAMS: THE RISING THREAT OF VOICE CLONING AND DEEPFAKES

As advancements in voice cloning and video generation advance, new risks and opportunities for exploitation are introduced. An individual needs only a few seconds of spoken audio from an individual to clone the person's voice; combined with the generally low quality of phone calls, distinguishing AI from a person is getting harder as these models advance. These scammers then ask for money from an individual; unlike regular scams, these AI scams thrive from the fact that many people are unaware this technology even exists or is possible for them; awareness is the biggest method of prevention by simulating a loved one in a desperate situation, scammers thrive off urgency.

Another increasingly common scam is deepfakes. Deepfakes simulate audio and video using AI models; scammers use AI to replicate an individual's voice and appearance, making them do or say things before the threat of being posted online. Deepfakes are a growing threat as AI technology creates an increasingly indistinguishable line between real and fictional. Scammers can fabricate scenarios of an individual that can result in blackmail.

The ease of creating deepfakes with publicly available content makes them especially dangerous. As this technology advances, distinguishing fake from real becomes harder, eroding trust in audio and video evidence. Awareness and education are critical in recognising and combating this growing threat.

The ease of creating deepfakes makes them especially dangerous, and the advancement of this technology would result in an erosion of trust or confusion regarding the validity of audio and video evidence. Awareness of recent AI advancements and scams is crucial in combating this growing threat.

HOW CAN YOU PREVENT AI SCAMS?

Education is important in preventing these scams, which, by AI's very nature, will continue to improve.

1.) Establishing a code or phrase that you and a loved one are aware of can be a simple but very effective method; it is free and simple and could make the difference in confirming an identity or unexpected or suspicious event. Otherwise, asking for personal information at the moment (such as pet names or street names) can be sufficient.

2.) Be aware of your online footprints

Being mindful of the personal content you upload online is a practical habit even outside of AI scams; identity theft prevention and maintaining a professional reputation are solid reasons to take care of your online footprints. Scammers thrive off your audio recordings, images, and videos to feed to models to replicate you; restricting access to this content reduces exposure

3 Stay familiar with AI tools and emerging technology:

Familiarise yourself with emerging AI tools and technology. By understanding the technology and how it can be misused, you can help prevent potential scams and take any necessary preventative measures.

J. B.

"Maybe AI is not so much about a skill but about skill application. When we are testing AI using intelligence test for humans that usually don't get useful results."

J. B. , in an interview on Machine Learning Street Talk



J. B. is a cognitive scientist, AI researcher, and philosopher known for his deep insights into the convergence of artificial intelligence, human cognition, and the philosophy of mind. Focusing on understanding consciousness and the future of AI, B. explores how machines can learn to think, model the world, and adapt like humans.

THE MIND OF MACHINES: UNDERSTANDING THE LIMITS OF AI LEARNING

Do machines truly have the ability to 'learn,' or do they mimic our behaviour? As AI evolves, it has sparked comparisons to human cognition, but how far does this parallel go? Humans don't just solve problems; we generate meaning with acts and intent based on prior experience, going through trial and error and drawing connections with our lived experience and conscience.

Contrarily, AI recognises patterns and makes predictions for an outcome similar to humans, going through trial and error, albeit systematically.

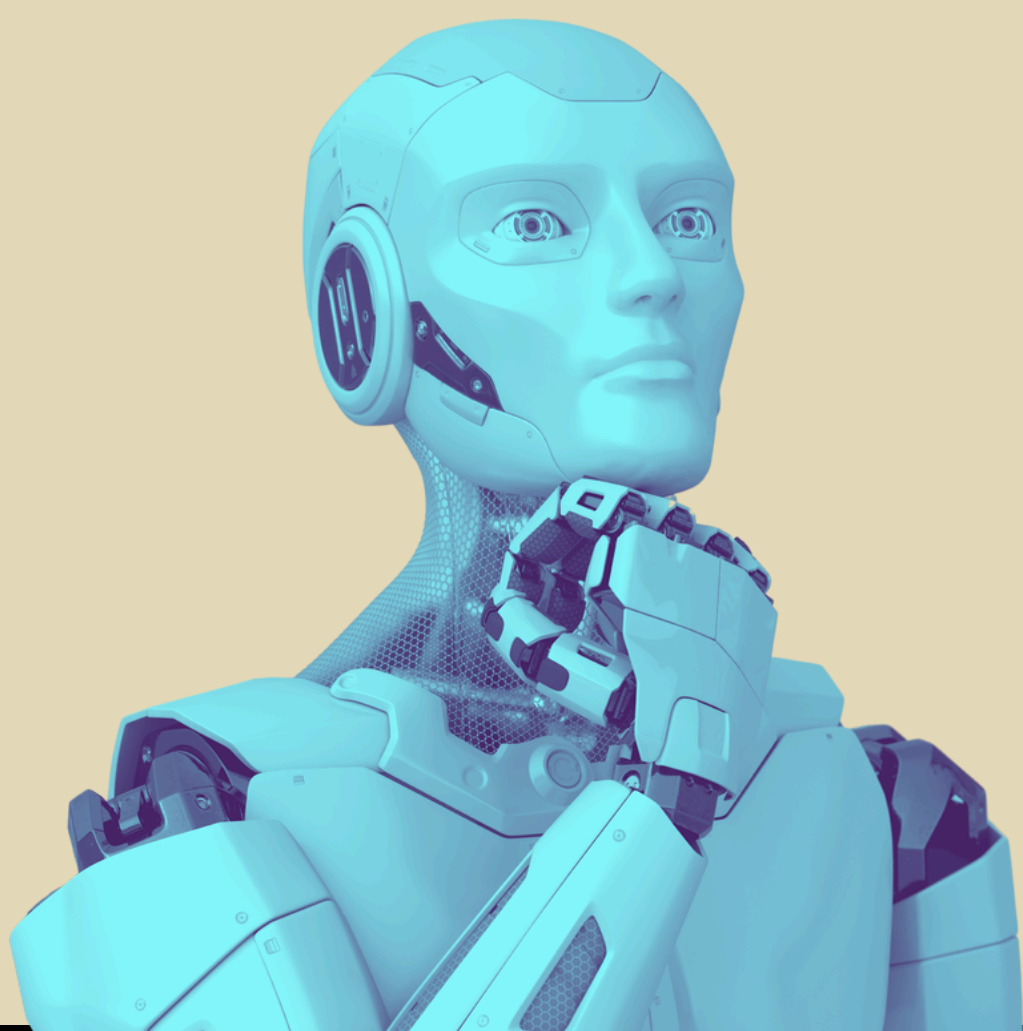
What differs, however, is creativity. AI has no prior lived experience as humans do; its version of 'creativity' is created through pattern recognition based on its training; no abstract thinking is involved, which is a fundamental requirement through creativity.

Similarly, AI can mimic human emotion, primarily to enhance communication, but it doesn't understand human thought or emotional logic. Without culture or experience, there is no foundation for genuine emotion.

These factors are the most noticeable missing features of AI compared to humans, but with AI's rapid growth, it is likely a matter of when, not if, AI can showcase these things.

The expansion of this technology raises questions that no one can truly answer, such as: When an AI expresses an emotion that deviates from its programming, is it truly feeling or simply mimicking?

THANK YOU
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OUR LIVES
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ISSUE 1



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